Part 3. Reflection and Adjustment

Group 3

Field selection and scope of analysis

We used the TOBOGGAN method to revisit the bookings after defining the seven questions for the monthly report. For each question, we checked which fields could answer it and how far the evidence from two hotels would take us.

To see when each hotel was busiest, we needed arrival dates and guest numbers. To understand how a market travelled, we also needed the guests' country, how long they stayed and how far ahead they booked. Together with nightly rates and cancellations, the records already covered those questions for both hotels. We could therefore leave market segment, customer type, deposit type and final reservation status out of the dashboard. A comparison across Lisbon and the Algarve as a whole would still need records from more hotels.

Country labels and market grouping

Reading the first country labels meant working out that PRT stood for Portugal and GBR for the United Kingdom before we could even compare the two markets. We switched to full country names so the comparison was clear on the chart itself. Across the 178 entries, we recorded each abbreviation, its display name and the source of that name. We included the older entry for East Timor and kept "Unknown" for bookings with no country recorded. That gave all 119,201 cleaned bookings a label, while "Other" let us group smaller markets in the overview of guest origins.

We interpreted CN as Canada because China already appeared as CHN and no other entry represented Canada. Under that assumption, Canada accounted for 1.1% of bookings and ranked 13th, leaving the ten largest markets unchanged.

Non-refundable bookings and Portugal's cancellation rate

Portugal stood out because 56.7% of its bookings were cancelled, compared with 37.1% overall. When we looked more closely, we found that many Portuguese bookings with non-refundable deposits had identical details. Leaving out the non-refundable bookings lowered Portugal's rate to 39.0%, which showed how much this group influenced the comparison. Without a booking identifier, we could not tell which repeats were separate reservations, so we kept them and added a note beside the cancellation figures.